very rare. But the potential for further violence and the intrusion of forces with no interest in compromise is very real, and this is starting to worry some neighbouring states who have substantial numbers of Rohingya refugees.[75]

This of course relates to the regular outflow of refugees from Myanmar, as many Rohingyas who have escaped live in appalling conditions in their new countries.[76] This creates a further set of risks. Left to make a living as best they can, some Rohingyas have become involved in running illegal businesses and criminal networks.[77] For those who have fled to India, they are also vulnerable to being targeted by a number of Islamist terrorist groups seeking to exploit any Muslim grievance, including Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB), and the Harkat-ul-Jihad al-Islami (HuJI). It should be noted that some of these groups quite deliberately offer humanitarian aid in circumstances where state or international bodies have failed, thus building up a client network.

Any Rohingyas who are radicalised by these groups pose a risk to their host country, which further undermines the limited status of Rohingyas who have fled as refugees. In addition, even though there is no evidence this has happened, there is a risk they might return to Myanmar. Given widespread suspicion of the Rohingyas, and widespread belief that they are funded by Saudi-backed extremists, any sustained terrorist campaign would inevitably set off a new round of inter-communal violence. Unlike in 2012, this time the Rohingyas are mostly isolated from the rest of society and are already held in camps. The likelihood of mass murder is all too obvious.

A natural disaster

Other possible triggers include a national crisis with its roots in an environmental or health problem.[78] Such a crisis is perfectly possible, especially given the pressures that climate change has already put on the region. We have seen how Cyclone Nargis may have played a part in encouraging the military regime to allow a return to limited democracy in 2008. A similarly destructive cyclone could badly undermine Myanmar's economy and leave the regime looking for scapegoats to divert popular anger.